OERizona
Open Educational Resources (OER) Standards

The purpose of these standards is to guide faculty who are designing OER for the OERizona Network, and they can be used for both a formal and/or informal review.

OERizona NETWORK REQUIREMENTS

Licensing

OER content is openly licensed including CC BY, CC BY-NC, CC BY-SA, CC BY-NC-SA, or in the public domain.	Y N

Accessibility

Content meets general accessibility standards Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.0, Level AA.	Y N

Shareability

The content can meaningfully and efficiently be combined or assembled with other materials.	Y N
The learning object does not require specialized skills or software to read/remix.	Y N

QUALITY

Currency & Longevity

The OER content is up to date but does not present information that will become obsolete quickly.	1 2 3 4 5
The OER content reflects significant, topical, and recent scholarship in terms of the subject matter.	1 2 3 4 5

Clarity & Accuracy

The OER content is well-written and contains no grammatical, spelling, or typographical errors.	1 2 3 4 5
The OER content information is factual and verifiable via other external sources.	1 2 3 4 5
The OER content is understandable and does not need to be augmented with additional explanation or material.	1 2 3 4 5

Comprehensiveness

The OER content scope covers all areas necessary for a particular college course or set of courses or specific course learning outcomes or module/unit learning objectives.	Y N

Readability

The OER content is understandable for the target higher education students.	Y N
The OER provides adequate context for any jargon/technical terminology.	Y N
The OER content contains clear instructions explaining how students and instructors are expected to use the content.	Y N

Source Transparency & Attributions & Copyrighted Materials

OER content cites references and sources appropriately.	Y N
OER content contains appropriate attributions for openly licensed content that you share or adapt.	Y N
OER content links out to all copyrighted content.	Y N
Refer to the Code of Best Practices in Fair Use for OpenCourseWare for all other copyright content that falls under Educational Fair Use.	Y N

Pedagogical Methods

The OER content includes multiple modalities (e.g., graphics, tables, and information other than text) to support student learning.	Y N
The OER content promotes active learning, class participation, and/or collaboration.	Y N

Organization & Format

The OER content provides an effective index or glossary, table of contents, or content outline when appropriate.	Y N
OER content reflects a sound organizational structure and approach.	Y N

APPROPRIATENESS & ALIGNMENT

Alignment

The OER content is appropriate for the course level.	Y N
The OER content clearly states student learning outcomes or unit/module learning objectives and demonstrates alignment.	Y N
Any relationships between the use of the OER course, textbook, and/or ancillary OER is clearly explained.	Y N
The OER content can be applied in some way that aids a learner's understanding.	Y N
The OER content facilitates the use of a mix of instructional approaches, if it is a larger object, like a unit.	Y N
OER assessments clearly describe how the assessment is scored using either a grading rubric or other scoring system.	Y N

Cultural Relevance & Sensitivity

The OER content is free of insensitivity or cultural stereotypes within the context of the subject matter.	Y N
The OER reflects diversity and inclusion regarding culture, gender, ethnicity, national origin, age, disability sexual orientation, education, and religion whenever possible, considering the context of the subject.	Y N N/A

TECHNICAL

Modularity & Adaptability

The text is easily and readily divisible into meaningful, smaller sections that can be reorganized.	Y N
The text is free of significant self-reference or interface issues, including navigation, that may disrupt if content sequence is modified.	Y N

Technical Quality

The image resolution and sound quality are up to current standards for target viewing devices (e.g., mobile devices).	Y N
The interface and design are easy to navigate.	Y N

OER REVIEW

OER content has been reviewed by Instructional Designers, Librarians, and/or Subject Matter experts through an OER review process.	Y N

SUPPLEMENTAL OR ANCILLARY MATERIALS

OER content that includes supporting resources such as study guides, labs, simulations, self-practice or assessment activities also meet these OER standards.	1 2 3 4 5

Attributions

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